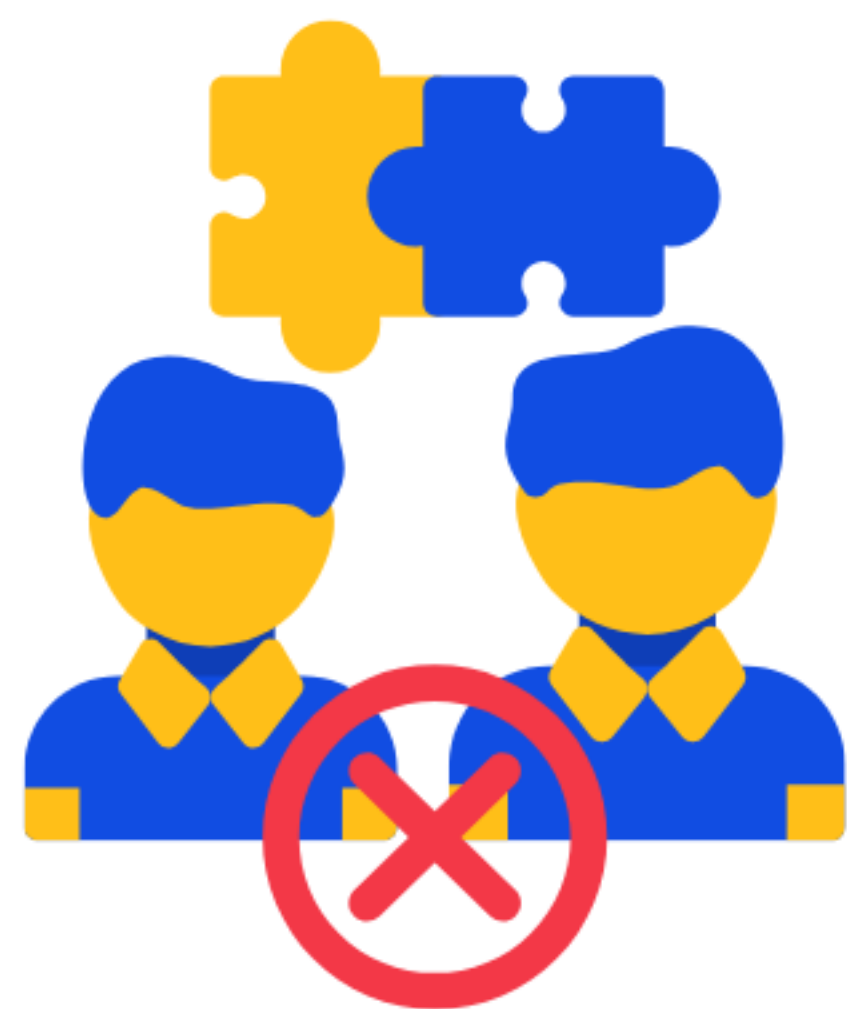


While not all challenging clients should be immediately disqualified, it is important to recognise potential red flags early to mitigate risks and ensure a productive engagement. Some warning signs to watch out for include:



### Lack of clear goals or constantly shifting objectives

If a client cannot articulate their needs or consistently changes their requirements, it may signal a lack of alignment or unrealistic expectations.



### Unwillingness to collaborate or accept expertise

Clients who are resistant to your recommendations or unwilling to provide necessary information or resources can hinder progress and undermine the value of your engagement.



### Insufficient commitment or resources

Clients who fail to allocate appropriate resources, including time, personnel, and budget, may struggle to see the project through to completion.



### Disregard for boundaries or agreements

If a client consistently pushes boundaries, requests excessive scope changes, or fails to adhere to established timelines and budgets, it can strain the engagement and erode trust.



### Ethical or legal concerns

Any indication of unethical or illegal practices should be taken seriously and addressed promptly, as it can expose you and your firm to significant risks.